Free Small Business IT Security & Fraud Checklist

22 yes-or-no checks: the IT basics that stop most break-ins, plus the invoice and banking red flags scammers count on you missing.

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How to use it: Tick each box that's true for your business today. Every unticked box is a gap. Fix them from the top of each section down.

1. Logins and passwords

- ☐ Two-step login (MFA) is on for email, banking, payroll and cloud storage
- ☐ Everyone uses a password manager, and no passwords are reused
- ☐ Former staff and old vendors no longer have access to any account

2. Backups

- ☐ Important files back up automatically, with one copy off-site or in the cloud
- ☐ We've tested restoring a file from backup in the last 6 months

3. Email

- ☐ Our domain has SPF, DKIM and DMARC set up, so others can't easily send email as us
- ☐ Staff know how to spot a phishing email and who to tell when one arrives

4. Devices and network

- ☐ Computers, phones and key software install security updates automatically
- ☐ The office router's default password is changed and its firmware is current
- ☐ The firewall is on, and guests use a separate Wi-Fi network

5. Invoices and changed bank details

- ☐ Before paying a vendor's **new** bank account, we call them on a number we already have, never one from the email or invoice
- ☐ We check the sender's address is exactly right (look-alikes like `vend0r.com` or `vendor-billing.com` are a red flag)
- ☐ Invoices are matched to a real order or contract before payment, especially from new or rarely used vendors
- ☐ Wires and new ACH payees over a set amount need a second person to approve

6. Impersonation and pressure

- ☐ Any "urgent, keep this quiet" request from the owner, a partner or a vendor for a wire, payment or gift cards is confirmed by phone or in person first
- ☐ Direct-deposit change requests from employees are confirmed in person or on a known number, not by email alone
- ☐ Staff know a real bank never asks you to read back a login code or move money to a "safe" account. They hang up and call the number on the card
- ☐ A familiar voice or face on a call isn't proof when money is involved (voices and video can be faked)

7. Bank accounts, checks and cards

- ☐ We've asked our bank about Positive Pay and ACH debit blocks, and use them where offered
- ☐ Someone reviews bank and card activity weekly, including small charges (a few $1 or odd-amount charges can mean a stolen card is being tested)
- ☐ Checks are mailed inside a post office or replaced with e-payments, and cleared checks are compared to what we wrote (payee and amount)

8. If something goes wrong

- ☐ Everyone knows the first steps: call the bank right away to request a recall, change affected passwords, then report it at ic3.gov. Speed is what gets money back

A few unticked boxes is normal. Start at the top of each section. Sections 5 to 8 are mostly habits, not software, so they cost little or nothing to fix.

Want a second pair of eyes? The **GNA IT Security Review ($149)** goes through these items with you on a call or screen share, with nothing to install, and gives you a plain-English report of what to fix first within 7 business days.

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